FREE CHECKLIST

DIVORCED DADS NOW

The First 72 Hours

HOW TO USE THIS

For the first three days after you're served, or after one of you moves out. Work down the list one box at a time. You don't need to win anything this week. You just need to not give anything away.

AS SOON AS YOU HAVE THE PAPERS

- [ ] If anyone is in danger, call 911. If there's a protective order, read it and follow it exactly.
- [ ] Read every page of the papers. Write down the response deadline, any hearing date, and any orders already in place.
- [ ] Don't answer your ex about the case. Not tonight.

ONCE THE FIRST NIGHT IS OVER

- [ ] Put each date in your phone with two reminders.
- [ ] Write down the kids' current routine: school, activities, bedtimes, medicine, who drives where.
- [ ] Start your parenting log (Worksheet 1). Today's entry only. The 12-month look-back gets its own page.

RECORDS AND PASSWORDS

- [ ] Copy the records you have a right to see: tax returns, pay stubs, statements, insurance. Nothing that belongs only to your ex.
- [ ] Change passwords on accounts that are only yours.
- [ ] Write down your questions for a lawyer.

LINING UP HELP

- [ ] Book three consults (Chapter 2).
- [ ] Tell one person you trust what's going on.
- [ ] Eat a real meal. Sleep. Make no decision you can't undo.

DON'T, FOR ALL 72 HOURS

- Move money, post, send the angry text, sign anything, or talk to the kids about the case.

IF YOU NEED HELP NOW

- If you or your kids are in danger, call 911.
- National Domestic Violence Hotline: (800) 799-7233. It helps men too.
- If you're thinking about hurting yourself, call or text 988.

From The Divorced Dad's Playbook, where Chapter 1 covers all of this in full. The eleven free fillable worksheets are at divorceddadsnow.com/worksheets. Educational information, not legal advice. *© 2026 Divorced Dads Now.*